

AFC Bank Product Innovation Strategy for Gen Z and Pensioners

Introduction

This document presents a detailed strategy for new banking products that AFC Bank (formerly AFS Bank) can introduce for two key segments: **Gen Zs (18 - 35)** and **Pensioners**. The recommendations are based on a comparative analysis of Zimbabwean banking institutions and identified gaps in the current market.

The research reviewed products offered by commercial banks, building societies, and microfinance institutions. The analysis shows that most banks focus on traditional offerings such as student and personal loans, and pension accounts, while several innovative opportunities remain underserved.

The objective of this strategy is **high-impact, easy-to-implement products** that align with AFC Bank's development mandate and agricultural heritage.

SECTION 1 : GEN Z PRODUCT OPPORTUNITIES

1 . AFC Hustler Account

Description

A low-fee digital account designed for freelancers, informal traders, gig workers, and young entrepreneurs.

How the Product Works

Users open the account digitally with simplified KYC requirements. Transactions from mobile money payments, and bank transfers create a financial activity record. This activity is then used to build a profile that qualifies the user for micro-loans.

Customer Pain Points Solved

- Lack of formal income proof
- Limited access to credit
- Difficulty opening traditional bank accounts

Improvements

- AI-based transaction credit scoring
- Integration with mobile wallets
- Built-in bookkeeping dashboard

Implementation

- Launch through AFC mobile banking and USSD
- Integrate with ZIPIT and mobile wallet ecosystems
- Introduce automated micro-credit triggers based on transaction history

Competitor Comparison

Bank	Similar Product
CBZ	Youth Account
Stanbic	BluEase KYC-Lite Account
POSB	Youth Account / Informal Traders Account
Success Microfinance Bank	Success Lite
Ecobank	Youth Banking
BancABC	N/A
Nedbank	N/A
First Capital	N/A
Steward Bank	Digital Wallet
ZB Bank	Youth Account
Metbank	N/A
AFC Bank	Proposed

Research shows that low-cost and KYC-lite accounts are already popular among Zimbabwean youth the high level of informal employment.

2 . AFC AgriStarter Kit

Description

A starter agricultural financing package enabling young people to enter farming.

How the Product Works

Young farmers receive a bundled offering including input financing, agronomy support, and access to buyers. Loan repayment aligns with the agricultural season.

Customer Pain Points

- High cost of farming inputs
- Limited access to finance for new farmers
- Lack of agricultural training

Improvements

- Digital farm management tools
- Climate insurance
- Satellite crop monitoring

Implementation

- Partnerships with seed and fertilizer suppliers
- Partnerships with commodity buyers
- Digital advisory platform

Competitor Comparison

Bank	Similar Product
CBZ	Agricultural Loans
Stanbic	Agribusiness Finance
NMB	Agriculture Lending
FBC	Agriculture Loans
Ecobank	N/A
BancABC	Agribusiness Finance
Nedbank	N/A
First Capital	Agricultural Lending
Steward Bank	N/A
ZB Bank	Agricultural Loans
Metbank	N/A
AFC Bank	Proposed

Existing agricultural finance products mainly target established farmers rather than first-time youth entrants.

3 . AFC Creator Wallet

Description

A multi-currency wallet designed for freelancers and digital creators earning income online.

How the Product Works

The wallet allows users to receive international payments, convert currencies, and spend locally using cards or mobile wallets.

Customer Pain Points

- Difficulty receiving payments from global platforms
- High remittance fees
- Limited multi-currency support

Improvements

- Integration with Payoneer and Stripe
- Automated tax reports
- Payment analytics

Implementation

- Partner with international remittance providers
- Enable Visa/Mastercard debit card support

Competitor Comparison

Bank	Similar Product
CBZ	Visa / Mastercard Accounts
Stanbic	Multi-currency Accounts
NMB	Visa Cards
FBC	Visa Cards
Ecobank	Rapidtransfer
BancABC	Visa Debit
Nedbank	Visa Cards
First Capital	Visa Cards
Steward Bank	Diaspora / International Remittance

Bank	Similar Product
ZB Bank	Visa Cards
Metbank	N/A
AFC Bank	Proposed

There is currently **no Zimbabwe bank product specifically designed for the creative economy** growing freelance and digital work sectors.

4 . AFC Study & Build Account

Description

A student account that evolves into a credit profile after graduation.

How the Product Works

Students open accounts with reduced fees. Financial activity during studies builds a credit profile later unlocks graduate loans and credit facilities.

Customer Pain Points

- Lack of credit history
- High banking fees for students

Competitor Comparison

Bank	Similar Product
CBZ	Student Account
Stanbic	Student Account
NMB	Student Account
FBC	N/A
Ecobank	Student Account
BancABC	N/A
Nedbank	N/A
First Capital	Ignition Student Account
Steward Bank	N/A

Bank	Similar Product
ZB Bank	Student Account
Metbank	N/A
AFC Bank	Proposed

Most student accounts in Zimbabwe do not transition into formal credit profiles after graduation.

5 . AFC RentFlex

Description

A financing product allowing young professionals to pay rent monthly instead of annually.

How the Product Works

The bank pays the landlord upfront and the tenant repays the bank monthly through payroll deduction or mobile payments.

Customer Pain Points

- Landlords demanding 6 – 12 months rent upfront
- Limited access to rental financing

Competitor Comparison

Bank	Similar Product
CBZ	Personal Loans
Stanbic	Personal Loans
NMB	Personal Loans
FBC	Personal Loans
Ecobank	Personal Loans
BancABC	Personal Loans
Nedbank	Personal Loans
First Capital	Personal Loans
Steward Bank	N/A
ZB Bank	Personal Loans

Bank	Similar Product
Metbank	Personal Loans
AFC Bank	Proposed

No Zimbabwe bank currently offers a rent-specific financing product tied directly to landlords.

SECTION 2 : PENSIONER PRODUCT OPPORTUNITIES

6 . AFC Golden Years Account

Description

A zero-fee account designed specifically for pensioners.

How the Product Works

The account offers reduced fees, simplified banking services, and priority branch support.

Competitor Comparison

Bank	Similar Product
CBZ	Senior Citizens Account
FBC	Senior Citizen Account
POSB	Pensioner Account
NBS	Seniors Account
ZB Bank	Heritage Account
Stanbic	N/A
NMB	N/A
Ecobank	N/A
BancABC	N/A
First Capital	N/A
Metbank	N/A
AFC Bank	Proposed

Several banks provide fee relief for senior citizens, showing strong demand for this segment.

7 . AFC Pension Advance

Description

A short-term loan allowing pensioners to access part of their upcoming pension payment.

How the Product Works

Loans are automatically repaid when pension payments are deposited into the account.

Competitor Comparison

Bank	Similar Product
CBZ	Salary Loans
POSB	NSSA Revolving Loan Facility
NBS	Pension-Backed Loans
FBC	Pension Loans
BancABC	Personal Loans
ZB Bank	Personal Loans
AFC Bank	Proposed

Zimbabwe already has strong pension-linked lending programs, particularly through NSSA partner banks.

8 . AFC HealthShield Account

Description

A medical savings account combined with healthcare discounts and emergency credit.

Customer Pain Points

- Rising healthcare costs
- Limited medical insurance coverage

Competitor Comparison

Bank	Similar Product
CBZ	N/A
Stanbic	N/A
NMB	N/A
FBC	N/A
Ecobank	N/A
BancABC	N/A
Nedbank	N/A
First Capital	N/A
Steward Bank	N/A
ZB Bank	N/A
Metbank	N/A
AFC Bank	Proposed

There are currently **no dedicated medical savings banking products in Zimbabwe.**

9 . AFC Legacy Savings Plan

Description

A savings account focused on inheritance planning and estate management.

Competitor Comparison

Bank	Similar Product
CBZ	Trust Services
Stanbic	Estate Planning
BancABC	Wealth Management
Nedbank	Estate Planning
Others	N/A
AFC Bank	Proposed

Most estate planning services in Zimbabwe are offered only to high-net-worth clients rather than pensioners.

10 . AFC Assisted Banking

Description

A support service helping elderly customers navigate digital banking.

How the Product Works

Includes assisted mobile banking setup, dedicated call support, and optional home banking visits.

Competitor Comparison

Bank	Similar Product
CBZ	N/A
Stanbic	N/A
NMB	N/A
FBC	N/A
Ecobank	N/A
BancABC	N/A
Nedbank	N/A
First Capital	N/A
Steward Bank	N/A
ZB Bank	N/A
Metbank	N/A
AFC Bank	Proposed

Research indicates that no Zimbabwe bank currently offers a formal assisted banking service more elderly customers.

Conclusion

Zimbabwe's banking market already offers several baseline products such as student accounts, personal loans, and pension accounts. However, the research reveals significant innovation opportunities in areas such as:

- Informal economy banking
- Creator economy financial services
- Youth agriculture programs
- Pensioner healthcare finance
- Assisted banking for elderly customers

By introducing these products, AFC Bank can position ~~itself as a~~ **development-focused financial institution that bridges generations — empowering young entrepreneurs while supporting retirees.**